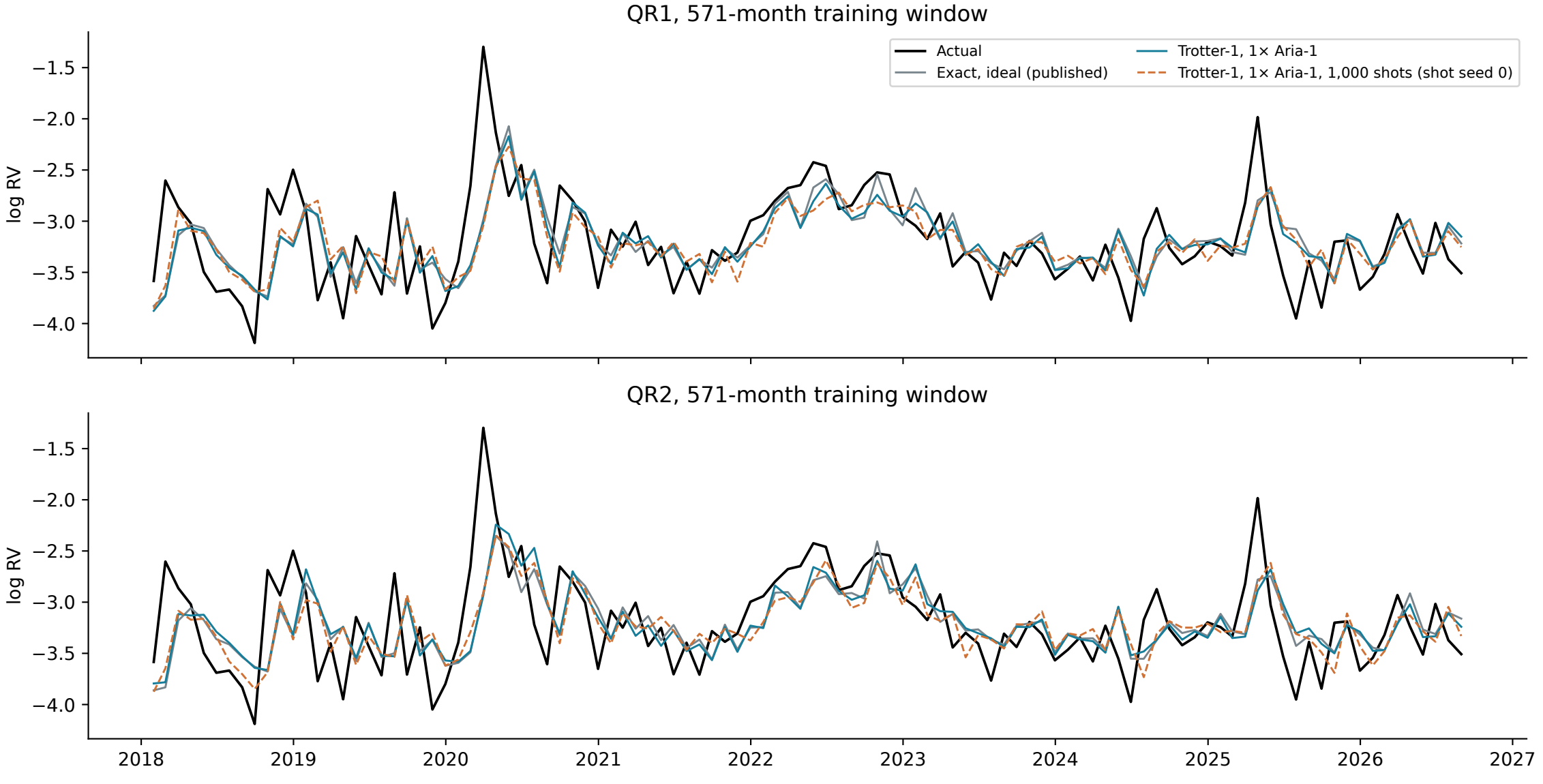Forecasts with and without noise